

Paytm — Evidence Summary

Edition 004 · Prepared 9 August 2026 · Independent research, not affiliated with Paytm, PhonePe or MobiKwik

Locked research question: How well does Paytm's loan journey help a user build an accurate mental model of who they're actually borrowing from and who to contact if something goes wrong — compared with how PhonePe, MobiKwik and Groww handle the same disclosure moment?

01 · The RBI event (verified directly against RBI's own press release)

On 24 April 2026, RBI cancelled Paytm Payments Bank's banking licence outright, effective close of business that day, under Section 22(4) of the Banking Regulation Act — the first time RBI has revoked a payments bank's licence entirely. RBI's stated grounds were general statutory violations: conduct “detrimental to the interest of the bank and its depositors,” and management “prejudicial to... public interest.” One97 Communications (Paytm's parent) states it has no financial exposure to PPBL and had fully written off its investment by March 2024. Paytm's personal-loan NBFC partners are separate legal entities, unaffected by this order.

02 · Where the lender's name actually appears (Paytm's own documented journey, 8 screens)

Screen	Lender named?
1. Entry / menu	No — Paytm-branded only
2. Eligibility check	No
3. Amount & tenure selection	No — user commits to loan size with zero lender info
4. Offer details	Yes — first appearance, smaller secondary text
5-7. KYC / e-sign / consent	No — not reiterated
8. Disbursal & repayment passbook	Yes — confirmed again

Key point: the lender is genuinely disclosed — Paytm's own FAQ confirms this. The finding is about timing, not concealment: the name arrives after the amount/tenure decision, not before it.

03 · Platform comparison, fixed criteria (Paytm vs PhonePe vs MobiKwik)

Criterion	Paytm	PhonePe	MobiKwik
Lender-name prominence	1 click, after offer generated	Varies: upfront in partner mode, hidden in NBFC mode	1 click, after offer generated
Grievance routing	App → Resolution Team → RBI Ombudsman (30 days)	App → Resolution Team → Nodal Officer → RBI Ombudsman	App → Resolution Team → RBI Ombudsman
Consent friction	Single blanket accept, no opt-out toggles	Single blanket accept, no opt-out toggles	Single blanket accept, no opt-out toggles
Partner-exit policy	Not publicly documented	Not publicly documented	Not publicly documented

The structural finding: none of the three platforms publish a policy for what happens to an existing loan if the lending partner exits — this gap is industry-wide, not Paytm-specific.

04 · Total cost of borrowing (disclosed APR ranges)

Platform	Disclosed APR range	Notes
Paytm	~9–15% p.a. (up to ~25%+ by profile)	Rate set entirely by the underlying NBFC partner
PhonePe	~10–18% p.a.	Varies by partner; several offer “no foreclosure charge”
MobiKwik	17.99–35.99% p.a.	Highest range of the three, despite MobiKwik now holding its own NBFC licence

05 · Claims explicitly rejected

Rejected — “Paytm hides who’s lending you money.” The lender’s name is shown on the offer screen, loan agreement and repayment passbook, confirmed against Paytm’s own documentation.

Not established — “Users are widely confused about their lender’s identity.” A dedicated search across reviews, forums and consumer-court filings found no documented complaint pattern on this specific issue — the strongest disconfirming-evidence result in this edition.

Not supported — “The RBI’s PPBL licence cancellation threatens your personal loan.” Paytm Payments Bank and the NBFC partners that issue personal loans are separate legal entities; One97 states no financial exposure.

Not supported — “MobiKwik holding its own NBFC licence makes it cheaper or safer.” Its disclosed APR range is the highest of the three platforms compared here.

06 · Priority experiments

Experiment	Confidence	What it tests
Know Before You Choose	High	Move lender disclosure to the amount/tenure screen, before the offer is generated
Partner-Exit Playbook	High	Publish a plain-language page on loan continuity if a partner exits, using the 2024 precedent
Multi-Offer Cost Comparison	Medium	Show side-by-side partner offers before auto-assigning one lender
Granular Consent, Industry-Wide	Medium-High	Itemised consent for what’s shared with the lending partner, replacing blanket acceptance

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